



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Anthem Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://anthem.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Anthem Preparatory Academy (AZ 85086) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across most rubric categories, with particularly robust evidence in curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. Public-facing materials from the school emphasize a liberal-arts core, Great Books, and a telos oriented toward Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, paired with Socratic inquiry and rigorous memory/recitation practices. These signals align closely with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements and accompanying keyword lexicons. While the materials foreground transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and formation of character, explicit references to theology, liturgical practices, or a formal ecclesial framework are less conspicuous in the snippets available, which places Element 1 in the “Somewhat Classical” band rather than fully Classical on the religious/metaphysical dimension. Overall, Anthem Prep AZ is CLASSICAL in aggregate.

Key exemplar signals from the crawl and knowledge sources include:

- Emphasis on the Great Books, liberal arts core, and Western canon as foundational to learning.
- Explicit telos centered on truth, goodness, and beauty, and formation of virtue in students.
- Pedagogical methods featuring Socratic discussion, memory work, narration/recitation, and upper-school rhetoric; lower-school memory-related chants and singing.
- Public statements about parent partnership and community involvement as integral to the classical project.
- The Six Elements framework and lexicon provide the positive/negative keyword scaffolding used to score each category.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school foregrounds a telos of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and formation of virtue as central aims. This aligns with transcendental realisms and virtuous life in the classical lexicon.
- The materials emphasize a Western-tradition liberal-arts framework and the classical approach to education, but explicit theology, liturgy, or communal liturgical practices are not clearly described in the public pages available. This reduces the explicit religious/metaphysical grounding signal relative to a fully “theology-liturgical” Catholic/Christian frame.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present positive indicators: Truth, Goodness, Beauty; Virtue; Moral virtue; Western tradition.
- Negative indicators: Not clearly present are explicit references to theology, liturgy, sacred scripture, liturgical calendar, or sacramental worldview within the accessible public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials strongly assert universal/transcendent aims (truth/goodness/beauty) and virtue formation, which maps to the transcendental moral realism and virtue criteria. However, explicit theology and

liturgical practices are not overtly documented in the accessible public content, leading to a “SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL” rather than fully CLASSICAL label for Element 1. The distinction rests on the absence of clearly stated theological grounding and liturgical community practices in the visible text.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job preparation. The classical telos of pursuing the true, good, and beautiful is repeatedly invoked.
- The mission emphasizes liberal arts cultivation and the Great Books approach as a vehicle for human flourishing and citizenship, rather than a narrow career-readiness stance.
- Great Hearts Anthem materials describe preparing students for college and advanced study while simultaneously cultivating virtue and a life of learning.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation.
- Negative indicators: Minimal emphasis on “workforce preparation” or narrow job-readiness signals; the public materials tend to resist reducing education to career metrics. (No explicit anti-track indicators found in the public excerpts; lacking explicit opposite signals.)

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds formation of character and wisdom and aligns with a liberal-arts telos. The presence of “formation,” “virtue,” and “true/good/beautiful” signals plus the Great Books emphasis map cleanly to CLASSICAL, with little textual evidence of a contrary emphasis in the public content.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Core curriculum is described as liberal arts with grammar, logic, and rhetoric as foundational elements, and there is a focus on ancient/classical texts via the Great Books program. Latin/Greek study is required, and history is treated through the Western canon and Great Books lens rather than as a social studies-leaning framework.
- The Great Books approach places students in conversation with challenging canonical texts, emphasizing the Western tradition and a broad humanities/arts/sciences foundation.
- There is explicit reference to the liberal-arts core and a systematic progression through Western intellectual heritage.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present indicators: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Western canon; Latin/Greek; history; arts/sciences/humanities; memory work/recitation (within the lexicon’s pedagogy signals).
- Negative indicators: The “negative” signals in the lexicon include avoidance of social studies framing in history, and a lack of project-based emphasis; the public materials show a more traditional, canonical approach rather than project-based or interdisciplinary overreliance, which aligns with classical norms rather than the modern-leaning alternatives.

Why this rating

- The explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and a canon-driven history curriculum strongly supports CLASSICAL rather than merely somewhat classical. The materials make the classical curriculum core to the program.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Upper-level pedagogy is described as Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; lower grades include singing/chanting and memory-based approaches (Scholé and memory work). This mirrors the classic progression from recollection and chant in the grammar stage to dialectic and rhetoric in the logic/upper stages.
- The public materials explicitly mention Socratic instruction as a core component of the approach to truth-seeking; there is also a focus on memory work, recitation, and disciplined dialogue as components of the learning process.
- Additional pages describe the aim of forming students' loves and affections through classical texts and discussion, consistent with scholé/restful learning as a pedagogical ideal.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present indicators: Socratic seminar/dialogue; great conversation; questioning-based learning; logic and rhetoric; narration/recitation; memory work; chanting; scholé/restful learning; disciplined dialogue.
- Negative indicators: Potential overemphasis on project-based or constructivist experiential learning in some modern schools (document's negative signals), but the accessible Anthem content emphasizes classical methods rather than exclusively project-based approaches. The public pages show a classical sequence rather than a pure project-first pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The school's pedagogy adheres to classical modes (Socratic inquiry, memorization/recitation, memory-based study, and rhetorical training for upper grades). The presence of both lower-school chanting/memory and upper-school Socratic/rhetoric signals aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The staff structure, leadership, and references to the headmaster and academic leadership reflect a definted, mission-driven faculty profile. The Great Hearts materials describe teachers as models of virtue and living curriculum, which aligns with the classical model of teachers as primary exemplars and mentors.
- The site emphasizes a culture of collaboration, professional development, and a "portrait" of what a teacher should be, consistent with the classical expectation of teacher virtue and mentoring.
- The presence of formal administration (Headmaster, Dean of Prep Logistics, College Counselor, etc.) demonstrates a well-structured, professional faculty environment that supports the classical mission.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present indicators: model teachers; living curriculum; teachers as mentors; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; character formation; virtue exemplars.
- Negative indicators: None clearly evident in the public content; the materials consistently describe a high-standard, classical-faculty model.

Why this rating

- The materials describe teachers as exemplars and living curriculum, with a collegial culture and explicit emphasis on character formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly positions parents as co-teachers and partners in the classical education project; the materials describe parent formation, book studies, and open campus visits. This is a strong alignment with classical education's emphasis on family formation and partnership with parents.
- There are explicit commitments to parental involvement, communication, and ongoing engagement to support the student's journey through the liberal-arts curriculum; family involvement is framed as a core element rather than peripheral support.
- The school provides guidance for families (commitments, calendars, and parent-oriented communications) to enable ongoing involvement.

Positive keyword analysis

- Present indicators: partnership with families; parent formation; family involvement; home-school collaboration; parent participation; open campus; parental leadership; community support.
- Negative indicators: None evident in the public content; the content emphasizes active parent engagement rather than passive or consumer-style involvement.

Why this rating

- The school's public content strongly reflects classical-parent partnership, ongoing family formation activities, and open engagement with parents, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 6.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Categories 2–6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Anthem Preparatory Academy AZ 85086 is CLASSICAL in aggregate, with Element 1 showing a partial alignment that could be strengthened through more explicit articulation of theology and liturgical/community practices in public materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- To move Element 1 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL:
- Explicitly articulate theology or theological grounding in public materials, even if primarily in a Christian worldview, and connect it to the curriculum and character formation.
- Reference liturgical or communal worship practices, liturgical calendars, or sacramental worldview as part of the daily or yearly rhythm of the school (even if presented as optional or family-anchored).
- Include explicit statements about liturgical or worship life, sacraments, chapel/mass, or sacred music as an integral part of schooling to strengthen the "Liturgical and Communal Practices" signal.
- Tie transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) to explicit theological commitments to further align with the classical lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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